CGIAR

Program Monitoring, Evaluation, Learning and Impact Assessment (MELIA) Plan

Scaling for Impact Program

June 2025

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1. Program overview and results framework

Scaling for Impact is fully aligned with the CGIAR Performance and Results Management Framework (PRMF) and supports the 2025–2030 CGIAR Portfolio outcomes. It contributes directly to key impact areas, including food security, poverty reduction, gender equality, climate resilience, and environmental sustainability. The program activates all three CGIAR impact pathways—research/knowledge advancement, government policy, organizational policy, organizational practice, and individual practice—through an approach that integrates research, adaptive management, and implementation. By applying system thinking, it links farm-level innovations with markets, finance, and policy in context-specific ways. It operationalizes the Innovation Packages and Scaling Readiness approach, enabling cohesive and scalable system-wide action.

The Scaling for Impact Program is CGIAR's flagship science effort focused on accelerating the large-scale uptake of agrifood innovations across food, land, and water systems. As the first effort of its kind spanning the entire Portfolio, the Program functions as an integrative hub connecting CGIAR Programs, Accelerators, bilateral projects, and partners to deliver inclusive, durable, and measurable impact. It addresses long-standing challenges to scaling, including fragmented delivery models, weak enabling environments, and limited responsiveness to stakeholder priorities.

The Program is structured around five interconnected areas of work. First, it strengthens demand articulation and alignment by embedding stakeholder priorities in research and scaling strategies. Second, it co-designs, refines, and delivers demand-responsive innovation bundles and packages through pathways adapted to biophysical and social contexts. Third, it diagnoses and strengthens policy, institutional, and market systems to support inclusive and responsible scaling. Fourth, it unlocks catalytic finance and enables new public-private and philanthropic partnerships to accelerate delivery. Fifth, it fosters adaptive learning and portfolio management, advancing scaling science and impact assessment through continuous feedback and learning loops across CGIAR's innovation ecosystem. CGIAR's comparative advantage is further leveraged through close collaboration with NARES, civil society organizations, and international financial institutions.

The Program's results framework is anchored in a robust theory of change and structured across 2030 outcomes, intermediate outcomes, and high-level outputs. S4I enhances CGIAR's capacity to deliver significant development outcomes by aligning scaling with public and private investment, especially with international financial institutions and governments. By 2030, and in collaboration with CGIAR's Science Programs, it will support more than 62 million people—at least 30% of whom will be women, youth, or underrepresented groups—with innovations that improve livelihoods and health. Biodiversity-friendly and climate-smart solutions will be applied on over 10 million hectares. S4I will create or improve 250,000 jobs and enable 480,000 people—half of them women—to access healthier diets. These impacts are anchored in a $5 billion development investment leverage goal.

Scaling for Impact is fully aligned with the CGIAR Performance and Results Management Framework and directly supports outcomes across the 2025–2030 CGIAR Portfolio. It contributes to key impact areas including food security, poverty reduction, gender equality, climate resilience, and environmental sustainability. The Program activates all three CGIAR impact pathways—research and knowledge advancement, government and organizational policy, and changes in organizational and individual practice—by linking research, adaptive management, and implementation. It applies systems thinking to connect farm-level innovations with market, finance, and policy systems in context-specific ways and implements the Innovation Packages and Scaling Readiness approach to enable coherent, system-wide action.

Theory of change

Narrative

Building on CGIAR's science and innovation, S4I supports the delivery of development outcomes at scale by strengthening conditions for the adoption of innovations across food, land, and water systems. Its Theory of Change (ToC) positions the program as a cross-cutting, system-wide mechanism that links research outputs to national priorities and delivery systems through interconnected impact pathways. S4I's contribution to CGIAR Impact Areas is guided by its MELIA Plan, which embeds learning, outcome tracking, and evidence-based adaptation throughout the Program lifecycle. This includes a focus on delivering inclusive benefits —particularly for women, youth, and other marginalized groups—by identifying where and how these outcomes can be optimized.

End-of-Portfolio outcomes by 2030: S4I's impact targets include **(1)** CGIAR Programs and 25 percent of new large bilateral projects will manage research and scaling adaptively in at least half of CGIAR's priority countries. **(2)** CGIAR's Scaling partners will extend to agrifood system innovations to over 20 million people, with at least 30 percent from underrepresented groups, including women and youth. These efforts will contribute to creating or improving 250,000 jobs and providing more equitable access to healthy diets for at least 480,000 consumers. **(3)** S4I's work to improve enabling environments for scaling will influence at least 100 policy or market changes, unlocking more than US$100 million in investment supporting 11 million agrifood system participants (e.g., farmers, businesses, and consumers). **(4)** S4I will leverage US$5 billion through IFIs and impact investors to embed CGIAR innovations in country-led, large-scale development programs. **(5)** More than 100 CGIAR and national partners will apply tools and methods for responsible scaling, innovation portfolio management, and impact assessment. These outcomes will be delivered through shared effort and co-reporting with other Science Programs and Accelerators, as S4I provides system-wide support services, rather than operating through direct delivery alone[1].

Intermediate Outcomes: S4I's intermediate outcomes reflect results within its sphere of influence—shaped by targeted interventions, partnerships, and system-level engagement, though not directly controlled. These outcomes rest on core assumptions in the ToC: that CGIAR scientists will respond to stakeholder demand to better prioritize research and scaling; that delivery partners will co-develop and implement scaling strategies; and that financing and policy systems will remain responsive to demand-driven innovation development. Acting as an intermediary across research, policy, and investment systems, S4I works to align incentives, reduce fragmentation, and support coordinated CGIAR-wide scaling efforts.

Through this influence, S4I supports CGIAR and NARES scientists in using demand intelligence to prioritize research and scaling activities. It works to enable Science Programs and innovation systems actors to co-design, bundle, adapt, and deliver Flagship innovations through carefully designed scaling strategies and actions. Policymakers and market actors are engaged in shaping enabling market, policy, and cultural conditions that support inclusive, sustained innovation use.

[1] Details on S4I's End of Initiative Outcomes are found in Annex 7 of the S4I design document.

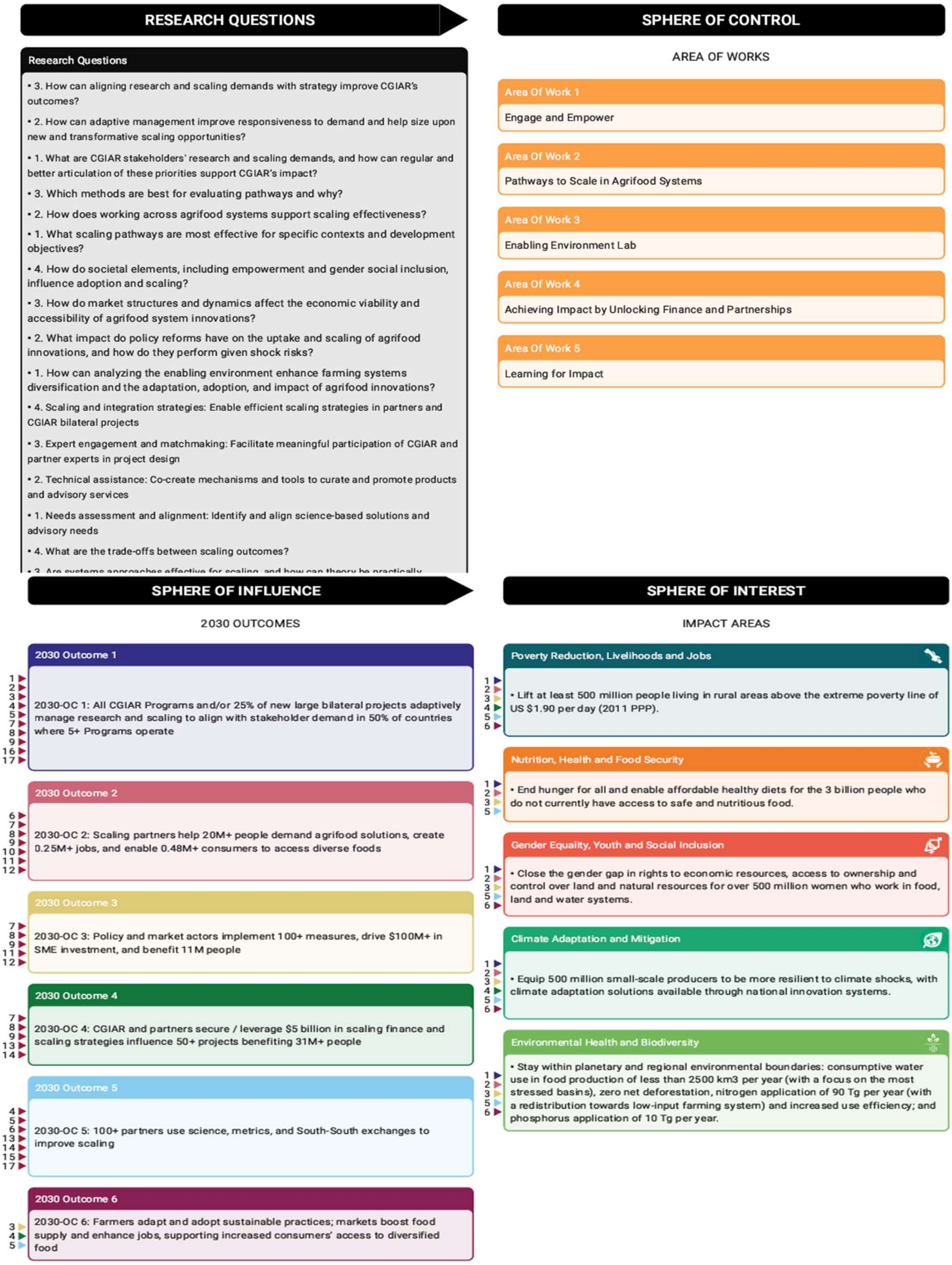
At the same time, S4I works with IFIs and impact investors to embed CGIAR innovations in national development programming and corporate social responsibility efforts. Over S4I's six years of implementation, 100+ non-CGIAR partners working in the development sector will be equipped with tools for improved innovation portfolio management, scaling readiness, and responsible scaling, reinforced by South–South and cross-regional scaling capacity improvements and learning. These outcomes are grounded in outputs generated across S4I's five AoWs, underpinned by a MELIA system integrated into CGIAR's overall performance management approach that supports adaptation, accountability, and collaboration across the Science Programs.

S4I's AoWs serve as the operational backbone of the ToC: AoW 1 enables adaptive CGIAR-wide Portfolio management by collecting, articulating, and actioning stakeholders' demands for CGIAR's research and scaling to support the Science Program's annual workplan activity (re)prioritization. AoW 2 maintains a focus on scaling innovations and is currently reconfiguring its action-learning cycle approach to integrate S4I's Scaling Flagships. These Flagships will be organized around thematically grouped innovations that face shared scaling constraints and opportunities, as described in Section 1.3, enabling clearer docking points for CGIAR Science Program and partner engagement, tailored support along common adoption pathways, and systems to speed delivery. AoW 3 enhances enabling environments by tackling policy, market, cultural, and institutional bottlenecks to scaling. AoW 4 supports the integration of CGIAR innovations into large-scale public development investment and impact finance mechanisms. AoW 5 embeds real-time learning and strategic portfolio management across relevant components of CGIAR's Portfolio. Together, the AoWs generate outputs that interact across impact pathways to support the achievement of the Program's Intermediate and 2030 End-of-Program Outcomes.

Inception Phase adjustments to the ToC: No AoWs, intermediate, or end-of-Portfolio outcomes have been added, nor any removed. Several structural changes have, however, been made. **(1)** AoW 2 is in the process of refining its approach to encompass the Scaling Flagships discussed in Section 1.3, each of which is anticipated to feed into existing HLOs. **(2)** In AoW 4, HLO 4.2, which focused on private-sector impact investment in scaling, has been merged with HLO 4.1, which embeds CGIAR expertise into international financial institutions and large-scale development investments. This merger brings a simplification to the overall Program design, and recognizes the common impact pathway—increased financial investment in scaling—shared between the HLOs. **(3)** To improve coherence and operational efficiency in AoW 5, Cluster 5.1 (Scaling science) was merged with 5.4 (South–South scaling exchange and learning). This consolidation shifted the focus toward applied, experience-driven support to strengthen innovation systems and enhance scaling outcomes. This resulted in a revised HLO under 5.1 (an Innovation systems agenda strengthening South–South learning and capacities to implement responsible and context-aware scaling strategies). MELIA has been updated accordingly, though the overall logic of S4I's ToC remains largely unchanged. **(4)** Funding to HLO 1.3 has been scaled back to \$0.5 M in 2025, with activities targeting a smaller sub-set of countries rather than launching a more ambitious multi-country plan. No further changes are anticipated before 2026; at this point, adjustments may be considered based on early Flagship performance in AoW 2.

S4I is supported by a blended funding model: Pooled (W1/W2) funds are used to sustain S4I's coordination functions, MELIA systems, enabling environment support, and cross-program alignment. Approximately half of S4I's provisional \$29.6 M 2025 budget comes from W1, the other half from W2 (AoW's-4 and -5 each having \$1.25 M W2 earmarks, respectively, with remaining W2 designations made at the Program level). These funds are concentrated on context-specific scaling activities, which the Program supports through scaling strategies and tactical guidance, efforts to address enabling environment challenges, and alignment of IFI and impact investments with the $44.8 millions of Center-led bilateral and W3 project investments mapped to S4I across 47+ projects[2].

ToC diagrams



[2] In 2025, S4I is supported by 47 of mapped W3 and bilateral investments, totalling $44.8 M ($0.42 M, $26.47 M, $1.55 M, $15.37 M, and $0.99 M across AoWs 1 through 5, respectively, with 74%, 19%, and 7% of W3 and bilaterals operating in Africa, Asia, and Latin America).

Results framework

The *Result Framework* presents a structured articulation of the intended results under CGIAR's strategic Areas of Work (AOWs) for the period 2025 to 2030. It distinguishes between two types of results: **High-Level Outputs (HLOs)**, which represent tangible, near-term deliverables from research efforts, and **Intermediate Outcomes (IOCs)**, which indicate progress toward longer-term development goals and systemic change.

Each result entry captures several key variables—among many others—that collectively define the pathway from research to impact. These include the thematic Area of Work to which the result contributes, the classification of the result as either an output or outcome, and a short title paired with a detailed result statement that describes the intended change, innovation, or contribution. The responsible organization(s), often CGIAR centers, are identified alongside any listed partners and outcome actors, with additional information on whether those actors are directly engaged and what type of change is expected from them (e.g., behavioural, institutional, or policy-related).

Geographic targeting is included where applicable, specifying relevant countries or regions, noting that CGIAR is still in a prioritization finalization process for 2026 forward. Quantitative targets are presented annually from 2025 to 2030, beginning with a target value for 2025. A cumulative target over the six-year period is also provided, offering a measurable basis for tracking progress.

While this framework captures only a subset of the broader data structure, it serves as a core component of the initiative's Monitoring, Evaluation, Learning, and Impact Assessment (MELIA) approach. It supports strategic alignment across CGIAR programs, enhances accountability to partners and funders, and provides the basis for adaptive management and continuous learning.

Linked to the Results Framework generated from the Theory of Change (ToC) Dashboard:

Please refer to the Results Framework attachment.

2. Monitoring plan for HLOs and outcomes

Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning: MEL tracks S4I's progress toward End-of-Program Outcomes, Intermediate Outcomes, and HLOs, as defined by the Program's ToC and its five interlinked AoWs. Targets are based on available resources, timelines, and expected contributions to Impact Area outcomes. Most indicators are drawn from CGIAR's standardized list and mapped to Portfolio Outcomes, with custom indicators added where needed. Quantitative indicators are prioritized for HLOs, while a mix of quantitative and qualitative metrics assess Intermediate and End-of-Program Outcomes. The MEL plan incorporates Independent Science for Development Council (ISDC) recommendations following the Program's design document submission to strengthen adaptive management and stakeholder alignment. It is anchored in CGIAR's established MELIA systems, builds on lessons from the RIIs and NPS, and is aligned with guidance from CGIAR's Portfolio Performance Unit to ensure consistency, coherence, and quality across Programs and Accelerators.

Progress tracking is coordinated through a MELIA Point of Contact (PoC) group composed of MEL specialists from all 13 CGIAR Centers participating in S4I, led by S4I's MELIA Focal Point. This group meets monthly and ensures harmonized data collection, analysis, and reporting, while providing regular feedback to the PPU and PCU, and supports data aggregation across AoWs. A detailed annual MEL work plan defines roles, responsibilities, and geographic coverage. In addition, S4I has approved 21 evaluation studies – a number that will grow over the next fiver years –to assess the effectiveness of scaling interventions and strategies, stakeholder engagement, and AoW contributions to Program outcomes. Studies have been prioritized based on strategic needs and, where possible, will be co-funded through aligned W3 and bilateral projects. Evaluation findings from CGIAR's 2022-2024 Science Group evaluations—particularly regarding how to measure the effects of adaptive management and scaling—have informed the management of S4I's MELIA system. Findings from evaluation studies will be primarily used to support adaptive management, while findings from impact studies will be used to report on outcomes and impact targets.

Data collection strategy

Given the implementation-oriented nature of the CGIAR Scaling for Impact (S4I) Science Program, its monitoring and evaluation strategy is quantitative and outcomes-driven, consistent with its system-wide scaling mandate. S4I primarily employs foresight approaches to identify, develop, deploy, and support enabling conditions around the scaling of innovation ecosystem.

All targets are in line with S4I's MELIA framework. High-Level Outputs (HLOs) and Intermediate Outcomes (I-OCs) are tracked based on the completion and deployment of innovations, as documented through annual and completion reports, and triangulated using Key Informant Interviews (KIIs) when needed. These data are collected annually and incorporated into programmatic reporting and adaptive learning cycles.

2030 Outcomes, which focus on adoption-level quantitative indicators, are assessed using reports and/or KIIs. These outcomes reflect broader system-level change, such as sustained innovation uptake, improvements in enabling environments, and policy or market shifts.

The approach relies on self-reporting by each Area of Work (AoW), with each AoW responsible for reporting on HLOs, I-OCs, and 2030 Outcomes, and maintaining supporting documentation and evidence to substantiate reported progress. Oversight is provided by the S4I MELIA unit, which coordinates data collection, validation, and aggregation across AoWs and ensures alignment with CGIAR's Portfolio-wide performance systems.

Data Quality Control

As outlined in the data collection methodology, and consistent with S4I's role as a system-wide delivery mechanism, the program will engage exclusively with CGIAR Science Programs, Centers, and implementation partners. Accordingly, the data quality strategy will consist of the following components:

- **Evidence Preservation**: All relevant documentation—such as meeting minutes, published guidelines, tool development records, training participation logs, innovation adoption reports, and policy outputs—will be systematically gathered and stored by the MELIA unit. These serve as the primary verification source for reported progress across Areas of Work (AoWs).
- **Reporting Accuracy**: AoWs are responsible for ensuring that their reports are fully aligned with preserved evidence. This includes an internal validation process within each

AoW prior to submission. Key Informant Interviews (KIIs) will be conducted selectively to triangulate results, and summaries of these interviews will be documented.

- **Verification**: Reported data will be cross-checked against the preserved evidence to confirm accuracy, completeness, and alignment with the defined indicators and targets, as articulated in the Theory of Change.
- **Consistency Checks**: All reported figures must be consistent with indicator definitions provided in the ToC results framework, ensuring clarity and comparability across reporting periods and AoWs.

Data Collection Frequency

Where possible, and contingent on an appropriate level of funding to S4I, data will be collected on an annual basis. As reporting period is calendar year by the end of November each year, all Area of Work (AoW) leads will receive a standardized reporting template that outlines their expected targets and deliverables following PRMS requirement. The results will be compiled and validated against supporting documentation. As part of the quality assurance process, meetings and/or Key Informant Interviews (KIIs) will be conducted with AoW representatives to clarify or verify reported results.

Following verification, the MELIA unit will submit it to the AoW leads and Program director for internal review and approval. Once approved, the finalized result will be entered into CGIAR's Performance Results Management System (PRMS) and used for Type 1 reporting.

3. Evaluation plan

A list of studies with relevant information is provided in Annex 2.

4. Impact assessment

Impact Assessment: The IA component initially includes six studies that will capture S4I's contribution to scaling impact and validate the achievement of outcome and impact targets. These studies will examine several dimensions and will differentiate and clarify S4I's catalytic role from scaling outcomes generated with other Science Programs and/or We and bilaterally aligned investments. IAs will focus **(1)** on the influence of demand articulation on adaptive management and scaling in other Programs, W3 and bilateral investments, **(2)** innovation adoption and use studies, **(3)** the influence of S4I on enabling environment enhancements, and **(4)** S4I's catalytic role in influencing and leveraging IFI and private sector impact investments, among others. Key indicators include adoption and use of innovations, including stakeholder demand intelligence, policy, institutional, and market systems influence, and funding leveraged. Studies will be concentrated in countries and regions where multiple AoWs and Science programs are active.

IA studies are implemented across AoWs and coordinated by S4I's MELIA unit, with scientific input from AoW 5's Cluster 5.2 on Dynamic Learning and Impact Assessment. This cluster collaborates with other CGIAR Programs and Accelerators to refine methods, share findings, and jointly commission cross-program studies on scaling and innovation systems. Funding combines program core resources and bilateral project contributions.

A list of studies with relevant information is provided in Annex 2.

5. Learning and adaptive management

Learning

The S4I Program will institutionalize a dynamic learning system that drives adaptive management across CGIAR. It will support continuous learning at both operational and strategic levels by embedding structured feedback loops, aligning research with stakeholder demand, and improving CGIAR's capacity to adjust in real time.

Learning will be supported through two interlinked streams:

• **Operational learning** that draws on real-time feedback from implementation to refine delivery models, partnerships, and innovation bundling processes across Programs and geographies

• **Strategic, research-informed learning** that integrates insights from scaling diagnostics, impact assessments, and Theory of Change reviews to guide program refinement and evidence-based decision-making

Under AoW 1, S4I will also support other CGIAR Programs in establishing and executing their **annual pause-and-reflect processes**, helping them to diagnose scaling challenges, realign priorities, and improve responsiveness to stakeholder needs. This includes co-developing institutional innovations to enhance adaptive management and coordination across the CGIAR Portfolio. Through these mechanisms, S4I enables CGIAR to move from fragmented scaling efforts toward a more coherent, systemwide approach—grounded in real-time learning, performance insights, and stakeholder demand.

Annual review and adaptive planning

S4I will institutionalize annual reviews as a core component of its adaptive management approach, building on CGIAR's emerging pause-and-reflect processes initiated during the 2022–2024 Portfolio. These structured reviews will provide a systemwide mechanism for reassessing stakeholder demand, identifying delivery challenges, and adjusting scaling priorities across Programs, Accelerators, and bilateral projects. S4I will support other Programs in implementing these reviews by providing diagnostic tools, scaling readiness assessments, and facilitation support to guide evidence-based adjustments. Insights generated will inform real-time refinements to innovation pathways, partnership strategies, and programmatic focus areas. This adaptive management process will be embedded in S4I's innovation portfolio management system, ensuring that learning is translated into action and that high-potential innovations are prioritized while less promising ones are retrenched or redesigned.

Under AoW 1, S4I will also strengthen the pause-and-reflect and adaptive processes of other CGIAR Programs by providing a structured mechanism for demand signaling. It will collect and synthesize data from governments, NARES, civil society, private sector actors, and other stakeholders to generate up-to-date insights on regional and country priorities. These demand signals will feed into program-level reviews, helping CGIAR Programs to align their research and scaling decisions with evolving stakeholder needs. S4I will offer technical support and evidence-based guidance to help Programs interpret and apply these signals during their annual reviews, promoting context-specific prioritization, reducing duplication, and enhancing the responsiveness and legitimacy of CGIAR's scaling portfolio.

Further details on this point will be further updated in subsequent iterations of the MELIA plan.

6. Reporting

Reporting is a critical process for both internal and external communication, ensuring accountability, transparency, and progress tracking. It facilitates decision-making, supports adaptive management, and communicates Program/Accelerator achievements to stakeholders.

This section outlines the types of reports required at different time intervals. It also aligns with the CGIAR Technical Reporting Arrangement (TRA) 2025–30 (in draft), which standardizes reporting processes and ensures coherence across funding streams.

An updated PRMS Outcome Indicator Module will be used to report results that evidence the achievement of outcome indicator targets. MELIA studies will contribute to this module and support reporting.

Further details on Technical Reporting processes, products and support will be shared in 2025.

7. MELIA resources

MELIA staff

The Monitoring, Evaluation, Learning, and Impact Assessment (MELIA) function within the S4I will be coordinated by a dedicated **MELIA Focal Point**. This role is central to ensuring alignment with CGIAR's performance frameworks and facilitating results-based learning and adaptive management across the program. MELIA activities are led by **the S4I MELIA Coordination Team. This team, which includes the S4I MELIA lead and includes MELIA team members from all Centres involved in S4I, acts as the primary liaison with CGIAR's Performance and** Results Management Framework (PRMF) and follow the guidance provided by the Portfolio Performance Unit (PPU) and the Portfolio Coordination Unit (PCU) to ensure S4I's MELIA efforts are aligned with broader CGIAR standards and processes.

Key Responsibilities of the MELIA Focal Point:

- **Support to AoW Leads:** Collaborate closely with Area of Work (AoW) leads to clarify and track their MELIA-related commitments. This includes regular communication of committed targets and timelines to ensure smooth and consistent implementation across all components of the program.
- **Data Collection and Reporting:** Lead the timely collection, consolidation, and submission of MELIA data. This ensures progress against indicators (HLOs and I-OCs) is accurately captured and reported in line with CGIAR requirements.
- **Adaptive Management:** Analyse findings and share insights with the program Core Team to inform strategic adjustments, improve delivery, and respond to emerging challenges and opportunities during implementation.
- **Learning and Knowledge Sharing:** Identify and document key successes, challenges, and lessons learned throughout the MELIA cycle engaging all the Area of Works. These insights will be used to inform future iterations of the S4I and contribute to organizational learning across CGIAR.

2025 MELIA budget

Activity title	Activity description	2025 total cost (USD)
Monitoring activities **(*Activities related to the routine monitoring of HLOs and outcomes*)**	Will incorporate it in the upcoming iteration.	
MELIA studies	As per annex 2	635,835
Total 2025 MELIA activities costs	Will incorporate it in the upcoming iteration.	

8. Data management

General approach

The Scaling for Impact (S4I) strives to implement a responsible, open, and secure data management in alignment with the CGIAR **Open and FAIR Data Assets Policy.** This plan outlines the approach to storing, managing, and sharing data generated through S4I activities, ensuring data is accessible, useful, and protected throughout its lifecycle.

- **Data Classification:** S4I will categorize data into three types: Open, Restricted, and Internal, based on accessibility and sensitivity. Each dataset will be tagged accordingly to guide storage and sharing protocols.
- **Data Storage:** If required, data will be stored in secure, backed-up environments using trusted CGIAR or partner infrastructures. File formats will be chosen for long-term preservation, and storage will support version control and redundancy.
- **Metadata and Documentation:** All datasets will be accompanied by standardized metadata to ensure they are findable and understandable, especially data curated under AoW5. Metadata will follow standards and include key details like origin, purpose, and licensing.
- **Data Sharing:** S4I will publish open data through CGIAR-approved repositories or global platforms as a mandate of AoW5 with compliance and ethical obligations.
- **Legal and Ethical Compliance:** All data activities will comply with data protection laws (like PII), CGIAR policies, and ethical research practices. Sensitive data will be anonymized, and necessary permissions will be secured before sharing.
- **Data Standard:** Throughout the data collection, curation, analysis, and reporting process the best standard process will be ensured to ensure the quality of the submitted report.
- **Monitoring and Improvement:** S4I will regularly assess and update its data management practices. Training will be provided to ensure all team members understand and apply CGIAR data principles effectively.

Annex 2. MELIA studies

MELIA Study title	Lead Center and Contact	Result Level	Result(s) evidenced by this study	Indicator(s) evidenced by this study	Assumption(s) assessed by this study	Geographies (scope)	Methods and design approaches	Other Program(s)/Accelerator(s)	Start Date for the study	End date for the study	Study Cost	How related to past evaluations (SG or others)
2.2.26 Evaluating the Scaling Potential of Decentralized GIFT Tilapia Seed Production Through Satellite Hatcheries and Outgrowers	WorldFish Sunil Siriwardena: s.siriwardena@cgiar.org	I-OC 2.2	Agricultural SMEs and cooperatives experience improved market systems with clearer regulations, economic incentives, and stronger public-private partnerships	Number of SMEs and cooperatives reporting improved market access or operating conditions due to clearer regulations, economic incentives, or public-private partnerships.	(i) Regulatory bodies are committed to transparency and inclusivity. (ii) Infrastructure projects are implemented effectively and in a timely manner. (iii) There is a commitment to public–private partnership.	Nigeria			May 2025	Sep 2025	20,642	
2.3.4 Pathway Assessment for Scaling Integrated Agriculture–Aquaculture (IAA) in Egypt Through Strategic Partnerships and Stakeholder Engagement	WorldFish Ahmed Nasr Allah: a.allah@cgiar.org	I-OC 2.2				Egypt	Literature review, expert interview/assessment, secondary data, primary qualitative data	SAAF	May 2025	Dec 2025	10,000	

MELIA Study title	Lead Center and Contact	Result Level	Result(s) evidenced by this study	Indicator(s) evidenced by this study	Assumption(s) assessed by this study	Geographies (scope)	Methods and design approaches	Other Program(s)/Accelerator(s)	Start Date for the study	End date for the study	Study Cost	How related to past evaluations (SG or others)
2.3. A Validating Growth Performance of G5 Rohu Through Structured On-Farm Trials Under Real-World Farming Conditions	WorldFIsh Hazrat Ali: h.ali@cgiar.org	I-OC 2.3	G Scaling partners deploy and iteratively evaluate scaling pathways providing evidence for stage-gating, adaptation, and amplification	Number of scaling partners that have deployed and completed at least one documented cycle of evaluation of a scaling pathway, generating evidence that informs stage-gating, adaptation, or amplification decisions.	(i) CGIAR Centers and Programs manage innovation portfolios, focusing on stage-gating and adaptation. (ii) The benefits of stage-gating are communicated to external partners. (iii) Partners engage in innovation systems to support scaling pathways.	SA	On-farm trials, participatory validation, performance tracking	SAAF	July 2025	August 2025	27,000	Builds on previous Rohu genetic improvement research and baseline trial comparisons from past WorldFish evaluations
2.3 A value chain study on rice- giant fresh water prawn in Cambodia	WorldFIsh Ou phichong: p.ou@cgiar.org	I-OC 2.3	Scaling partners deploy and iteratively evaluate scaling pathways providing evidence for stage-gating,	Number of scaling partners that have deployed and completed at least one documented cycle of evaluation of a	Number of scaling partners that have deployed and completed at least one documented cycle of evaluation of a	Cambodia	Qualitative, on-farm experiment	ASEAN CGIAR IP 1+	Feb 2025	Sep 2025		

MELIA Study title	Lead Center and Contact	Result Level	Result(s) evidenced by this study	Indicator(s) evidenced by this study	Assumption(s) assessed by this study	Geographies (scope)	Methods and design approaches	Other Program(s)/Accelerator(s)	Start Date for the study	End date for the study	Study Cost	How related to past evaluations (SG or others)
			adaptation, and amplification	scaling pathway, generating evidence that informs stage-gating, adaptation, or amplification decisions.	scaling pathway, generating evidence that informs stage-gating, adaptation, or amplification decisions.							
2.3.17 Access the opportunity: Scaling Climate-Resilient Ricefield Pond Innovations for Sustainable Food Systems in Cambodia	WorldFIsh Sean, Vichet: V.Sean@cgiar.org	I-OC 2.3	Scaling partners deploy and iteratively evaluate scaling pathways providing evidence for stage-gating, adaptation, and amplification	Number of scaling partners that have deployed and completed at least one documented cycle of evaluation of a scaling pathway, generating evidence that informs stage-gating, adaptation, or amplification decisions.	Number of scaling partners that have deployed and completed at least one documented cycle of evaluation of a scaling pathway, generating evidence that informs stage-gating, adaptation, or amplification decisions.	Cambodia	Quantitative data from on-farm trials	Climate Action	Jun 2025	Oct 2025		
3.1.3 Quantitative assessment to identify specific development programs in Central	IFPRI Manuel Hernandez: m.a.hernandez@cgiar.org	I-OC 3.1	Governments, market actors, and partners use evidence generated by AoW 3 to inform policies and	Number of policy/market, regulatory, and/or institutional interventions made by governments,	(i) There is ongoing support and collaboration from partners. (ii) Stakeholders are receptive	LAC	Quantitative approach using primary and secondary data	Food Frontiers and Security	Jun 2025	Dec 2025	55,126	Builds on work started in AgriLAC

MELIA Study title	Lead Center and Contact	Result Level	Result(s) evidenced by this study	Indicator(s) evidenced by this study	Assumption(s) assessed by this study	Geographies (scope)	Methods and design approaches	Other Program(s)/Accelerator(s)	Start Date for the study	End date for the study	Study Cost	How related to past evaluations (SG or others)
America that can be most effective in addressing agricultural market distortions, boost agricultural productivity, and prevent vulnerable populations, including women and youth in fragile settings, to relocate or emigrate.			institutional changes that address enabling environment barriers	market actors, or partners that explicitly reference and/or are demonstrably informed by AoW 3 evidence.	to using new tools and insights. (iii) Reliable data is available. (iv) Stakeholders can be incentivized to engage in research activities.							
3.1.7 Assessing the Role of District-Level Platforms in Strengthening Water Governance and Resource Sustainability in Cambodia.	WorldFIsh Sao Sok:sao.sok@cgiar.org	I-OC 3.1	Governments, market actors, and partners use evidence generated by AoW 3 to inform policies and institutional changes that address enabling environment barriers	Number of policy/market, regulatory, and/or institutional interventions made by governments, market actors, or partners that explicitly reference and/or are demonstrably informed by AoW 3 evidence.	(i) There is ongoing support and collaboration from partners. (ii) Stakeholders are receptive to using new tools and insights. (iii) Reliable data is available. (iv) Stakeholders can be	Cambodia	Representative survey, stakeholder mapping, livelihood and governance comparative analysis	SAAF	Aug 2025	Nov 2025	12,000	

MELIA Study title	Lead Center and Contact	Result Level	Result(s) evidenced by this study	Indicator(s) evidenced by this study	Assumption(s) assessed by this study	Geographies (scope)	Methods and design approaches	Other Program(s)/Accelerator(s)	Start Date for the study	End date for the study	Study Cost	How related to past evaluations (SG or others)
					incentivized to engage in research activities.							
3.1.9. Women empowerment and adoption of digital extension and good agricultural practices	AfricaRice Aminou Arouna a.arouna@cgiar.org	I-OC 3.1	Governments, market actors, and partners use evidence generated by AoW 3 to inform policies and institutional changes that address enabling environment barriers	Number of policy/market, regulatory, and/or institutional interventions made by governments, market actors, or partners that explicitly reference and/or are demonstrably informed by AoW 3 evidence.	(i) There is ongoing support and collaboration from partners. (ii) Stakeholders are receptive to using new tools and insights. (iii) Reliable data is available. (iv) Stakeholders can be incentivized to engage in research activities.	Nigeria	Randomized control trial	SFP	Jun 2025	Dec 2025	60000	
3.1.18. Risk aversion and adoption of stress tolerant varieties: experimental approach	AfricaRice Aminou Arouna a.arouna@cgiar.org	I-OC 3.1	Governments, market actors, and partners use evidence generated by AoW 3 to inform policies and	Number of policy/market, regulatory, and/or institutional interventions made by governments, market actors,	(i) There is ongoing support and collaboration from partners. (ii) Stakeholders are receptive	Cote d'Ivoire	Experimental method	SFP	Jun 2025	Dec 2025	50000	

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			institutional changes that address enabling environment barriers	or partners that explicitly reference and/or are demonstrably informed by AoW 3 evidence.	to using new tools and insights. (iii) Reliable data is available. (iv) Stakeholders can be incentivized to engage in research activities.							
3.2.4. EE assessments and action plans: Guidelines for gender-sensitive scaling of integrated Nexus approaches in saline water and agrifood systems developed and tested(considering PS role in finance)	IWMI Sawsan, Gharaibeh s.gharaibeh@cgiar.org	i-OC 3.2	Agricultural SMEs and cooperatives experience improved market systems with clearer regulations, economic incentives, and stronger public-private partnerships	Number of SMEs and cooperatives reporting improved market access or operating conditions due to clearer regulations, economic incentives, or public-private partnerships.	(i) Regulatory bodies are committed to transparency and inclusivity. (ii) Infrastructure projects are implemented effectively and in a timely manner. (iii) There is a commitment to public–private partnership.	Egypt		GESI, Policy Innovation, Climate Action	Jun 2025	Dec 2025	50,000	Build on study initiated under CWANA in Egypt
3.2.8. EE assessments and action	IWMI Maha Ai-Zu'bi	i-OC 3.2	Agricultural SMEs and cooperatives	Number of SMEs and cooperatives	(i) Regulatory bodies are committed to	Morocco		Climate Action, Policy Innovation	Jun 2025	Dec 2025	10,000	Build on study initiated under

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plans (Fragility Index maps/tool)	m.al-zubi@cgiar.org		experience improved market systems withclearer regulations, economic incentives, and stronger public-private partnerships	reporting improved market access or operating conditions due to clearer regulations, economic incentives, or public-private partnerships.	transparency and inclusivity. (ii) Infrastructure projects are implemented effectively and in a timely manner. (iii) There is a commitment to public–private partnership.							CWANA in Morocco
5.2.8. Ex-post impact of adoption of improved rice varieties	Africa Rice Center Aminou, Arouna: a.arouna@cgiar.org	I-OC 5.2	Scaling actors are informed and use evidence-based recommendations for short, medium, and long-term optimal and responsible scaling processes and pathways	Number of scaling actors (partners, institutions, organizations) who report using evidence-based recommendations from CGIAR to guide short-, medium-, or long-term scaling decisions.	There is sufficient investment available and timely design of research and MELIA.	Cote d'Ivoire, Nigeria	Experimental method	SFP	Jun 2025	Dec 2025	75,000	
5.2.8. Ex-post impact assessment of	Africa Rice Center Aminou, Arouna:	I-OC 5.2	Scaling actors are informed and use evidence-	Number of scaling actors (partners, institutions,	There is sufficient investment available and	Cote d'Ivoire	Observational study		Sep 2025	Dec 2025	50,000	

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rice parboiling technologies	a.arouna@cgiar.org		based recommendations for short, medium, and long-term optimal and responsible scaling processes and pathways	organizations) who report using evidence-based recommendations from CGIAR to guide short-, medium-, or long-term scaling decisions.	timely design of research and MELIA.							
5.2.9. Ex-ante impact assessment of Soy agronomy digital advisory tool	IITA Adane Tufa: A.Tufa@cgiar.org;	I-OC 5.2	Scaling actors are informed and use evidence-based recommendations for short, medium, and long-term optimal and responsible scaling processes and pathways	Number of scaling actors (partners, institutions, organizations) who report using evidence-based recommendations from CGIAR to guide short-, medium-, or long-term scaling decisions.	There is sufficient investment available and timely design of research and MELIA.	ESA/Zambia, Malawi	Literature review, expert interview/assessment, secondary data, primary data (qualitative and quantitative)	SFP	Jun 2025	Dec 2025	32,099	
5.2.2 An assessment conducted to generate preliminary evidence on	WorldFish Khondker Murshed-e-Jahan: k.murshed-e-	I-OC 5.2	Scaling actors are informed and use evidence-based recommendat	Number of scaling actors (partners, institutions, organizations) who report	There is sufficient investment available and timely design	Bangladesh	Panel survey, longitudinal tracking, comparative analysis	SAAF	Jul 2025	Nov 2025	20,000	

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improved genetics and aquaculture interventions in Bangladesh	jahan@cgiar.org		ions for short, medium, and long-term optimal and responsible scaling processes and pathways	using evidence-based recommendations from CGIAR to guide short-, medium-, or long-term scaling decisions.	of research and MELIA.							
5.2.2 A study to assess nutrition consumption and production among households in Lower Mekong Delta and Cambodia	WorldFish Sokcheng Phay: s.phay@cgiar.org	I-OC 5.2	Scaling actors are informed and use evidence-based recommendations for short, medium, and long-term optimal and responsible scaling processes and pathways	Number of scaling actors (partners, institutions, organizations) who report using evidence-based recommendations from CGIAR to guide short-, medium-, or long-term scaling decisions.	There is sufficient investment available and timely design of research and MELIA.	Lower Mekong Delta and Cambodia	LMD and national representative data	SAAF, Better diets and nutrition	Jun 2025	Nov 2025	10,000	
5.2. Impact of demonstration plot density and digital advisory on knowledge and adoption behavior of	CIMMYT Kelvin Hicingabula Mulungu: k.mulungu@cgiar.org	I-OC 5.2	Scaling actors are informed and use evidence-based recommendations for short, medium, and	Number of scaling actors (partners, institutions, organizations) who report using evidence-	There is sufficient investment available and timely design of research and MELIA.	Zambia	Randomized control trial	SFP	Nov 2022	Oct 2025	40,000	Builds on work started under a bilateral project - AID-I, only pending activity is endline evaluation

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farmers: Evidence from a randomized evaluation in Zambia			long-term optimal and responsible scaling processes and pathways	based recommendations from CGIAR to guide short-, medium-, or long-term scaling decisions.								
5.2. Small Seed Packs, Big Potential? Effect of Seed Packs on Knowledge and Adoption of Improved Crop Varieties	CIMMYT Hambulo Ngoma: h.ngoma@cgiar.org	I-OC 5.2	Scaling actors are informed and use evidence-based recommendations for short, medium, and long-term optimal and responsible scaling processes and pathways	Number of scaling actors (partners, institutions, organizations) who report using evidence-based recommendations from CGIAR to guide short-, medium-, or long-term scaling decisions.	There is sufficient investment available and timely design of research and MELIA.	ESA (Tanzania and Zambia)	Survey, experimental method	SFP	Oct 2023	Oct 2025	5,000	Builds on data collected using bilateral funding, this is a contribution to staff time for analysis and writing
5.2. Effect of agricultural digital advisories on adoption of promoted practices: Evidence from a mass campaign in	CIMMYT Kelvin Hicingabula Mulungu: k.mulungu@cgiar.org	I-OC 5.2	Scaling actors are informed and use evidence-based recommendations for short, medium, and long-term optimal and	Number of scaling actors (partners, institutions, organizations) who report using evidence-based recommendat	There is sufficient investment available and timely design of research and MELIA.	ESA (Malawi and Zambia)	Survey, experimental method	SFP	Oct 2023	Nov 2025	5,000	Builds on data collected using bilateral funding, this is a contribution to staff time for analysis and writing

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Zambia and Malawi			responsible scaling processes and pathways	ions from CGIAR to guide short-, medium-, or long-term scaling decisions.								
5.2. Information Sharing within Agricultural Households: Evidence from a Randomized Messaging Experiment in Malawi and Zambia	CIMMYT Kelvin Hicingabula Mulungu: k.mulungu@cgiar.org	I-OC 5.2	Scaling actors are informed and use evidence-based recommendations for short, medium, and long-term optimal and responsible scaling processes and pathways	Number of scaling actors (partners, institutions, organizations) who report using evidence-based recommendations from CGIAR to guide short-, medium-, or long-term scaling decisions.	There is sufficient investment available and timely design of research and MELIA.	ESA (Malawi and Zambia)	Survey, experimental method	SFP	Oct 2023	Nov 2025	5,000	Builds on data collected using bilateral funding, this is a contribution to staff time for analysis and writing
5.2. Adoption and diffusion of sustainable intensification and mechanization technologies in East and Southern Africa: Evidence from five countries	CIMMYT Hambulo Ngoma: h.ngoma@cgiar.org	I-OC 5.2	Scaling actors are informed and use evidence-based recommendations for short, medium, and long-term optimal and responsible scaling	Number of scaling actors (partners, institutions, organizations) who report using evidence-based recommendations from CGIAR to	There is sufficient investment available and timely design of research and MELIA.	ESA (Ethiopia, Kenya, Malawi, Zambia, and Zimbabwe)	Survey, experimental method	SFP	Sep 2023	Nov 2025	5,000	Builds on data collected using the CGIAR initiative (UU) funding, this is a contribution to staff time for analysis and writing

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			processes and pathways	guide short-, medium-, or long-term scaling decisions.								
5.2. Fast tracking innovation scaling: Lessons from FAW tolerant maize varieties in Zambia	CIMMYT Hambulo Ngoma: h.ngoma@cgiar.org	I-OC 5.2	Scaling actors are informed and use evidence-based recommendations for short, medium, and long-term optimal and responsible scaling processes and pathways	Number of scaling actors (partners, institutions, organizations) who report using evidence-based recommendations from CGIAR to guide short-, medium-, or long-term scaling decisions.	There is sufficient investment available and timely design of research and MELIA.	Zambia	Observational study	SFP	May 2025	Jul 2025	3,500	Builds on work started using bilateral funding, this is a contribution to staff time for analysis and writing
5.2. Economic, environmental and poverty benefits of conservation agriculture in Zambia	CIMMYT Kelvin Hicingabula Mulungu: k.mulungu@cgiar.org	I-OC 5.2	Scaling actors are informed and use evidence-based recommendations for short, medium, and long-term optimal and responsible scaling processes and pathways	Number of scaling actors (partners, institutions, organizations) who report using evidence-based recommendations from CGIAR to guide short-, medium-, or	There is sufficient investment available and timely design of research and MELIA.	Zambia	Survey, experimental method	SFP	Jan 2025	Aug 2025	5,000	Builds on data collected using bilateral funding, this is a contribution to staff time for analysis and writing

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				long-term scaling decisions.								
5.2. Does trust in extension systems influence adoption of conservation agriculture in Southern Africa: Insights from lab in the field experiments	CIMMYTHambulo Ngoma: h.ngoma@cgiar.org	I-OC 5.2	Scaling actors are informed and use evidence-based recommendations for short, medium, and long-term optimal and responsible scaling processes and pathways	Number of scaling actors (partners, institutions, organizations) who report using evidence-based recommendations from CGIAR to guide short-, medium-, or long-term scaling decisions.	There is sufficient investment available and timely design of research and MELIA.	ESA (Malawi, Zambia and Zimbabwe)	Survey, experimental method	MFL	Jun 2024	Dec 2025	5,000	Builds on data collected using the CGIAR initiative (UU) funding, this is a contribution to staff time for analysis and writing
5.2. Heterogenous impacts of the Pfumvudza program on welfare: Panel data evidence from Zimbabwe	CIMMYTHambulo Ngoma: h.ngoma@cgiar.org	I-OC 5.2	Scaling actors are informed and use evidence-based recommendations for short, medium, and long-term optimal and responsible scaling processes and pathways	Number of scaling actors (partners, institutions, organizations) who report using evidence-based recommendations from CGIAR to guide short-, medium-, or long-term	There is sufficient investment available and timely design of research and MELIA.	Zimbabwe	Panel survey, longitudinal tracking, comparative analysis	MFL	Mar 2021	Dec 2025	5,000	Builds on data collected using bilateral funding, this is a contribution to staff time for analysis and writing

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				scaling decisions.								
Adoption study on straw management practices, alternative fertilizer and fertilizer use efficiency in rice production in Vietnam	ABC Byron Reyes: b.reyes@cgiar.org	I-OC 5.2	Scaling actors are informed and use evidence-based recommendations for short, medium, and long-term optimal and responsible scaling processes and pathways	Number of scaling actors (partners, institutions, organizations) who report using evidence-based recommendations from CGIAR to guide short-, medium-, or long-term scaling decisions.	There is sufficient investment available and timely design of research and MELIA.	Guatemala	Survey		Jul 2025	Dec 2025	40,000	Uses baseline survey data collected under AgriLAC, and collaborates with AoW3 to include other nodes in the value chain, in the analysis, to provide comprehensive results beyond farmer-level results